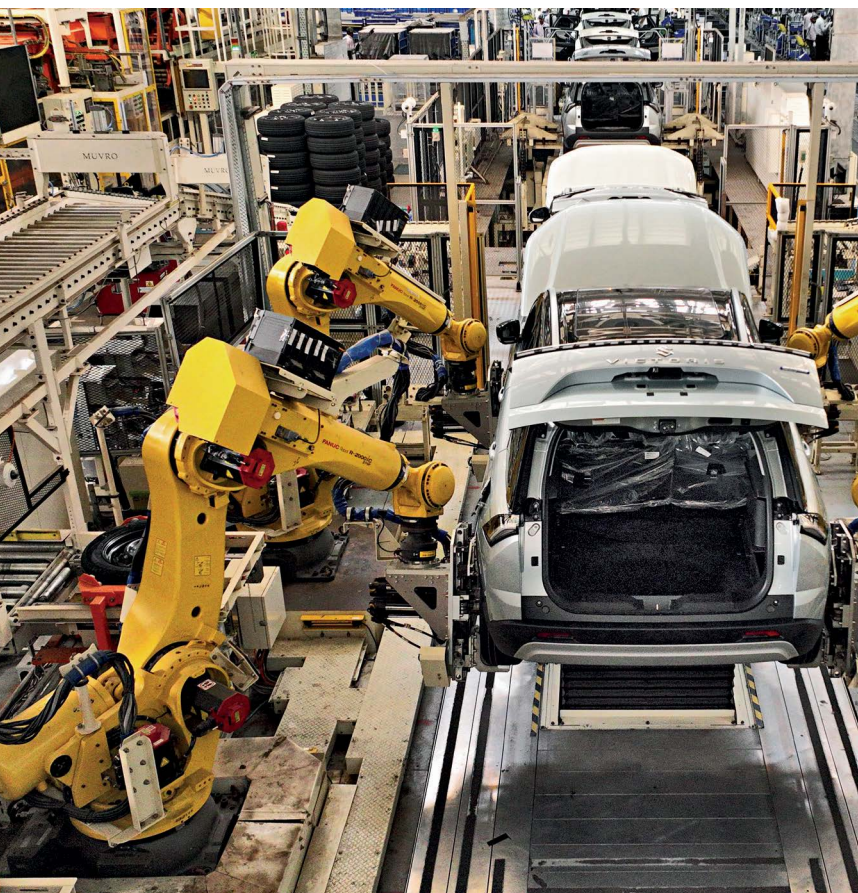




Maruti Suzuki expects 15% of sales to come from BEVs by FY31

ALL ABOUT MARUTI

Maruti Suzuki's exports rose 28% YoY to 123,330 units in Q1FY27. e-VITARA was India's 3rd top exported PV model

Currently operates four manufacturing units, three of which are located in Haryana at Gurugram, Manesar, and Kharkhoda, while the fourth is at Hansalpur, Gujarat

India's PV market leader is setting up a new greenfield plant with one million units of capacity in Gujarat with an investment of ₹35,000 crore. It is expected to start operations in 2029

Maruti Suzuki added 500,000 units capacity in the first four months of FY27, taking its annual capacity to 2.9 million units

tion. Wherever our customers go, they can get service and necessary parts," he says.

CATCHING UP ON EVs

With the launch of its maiden battery electric vehicle (BEV), the e-Vitara, earlier in 2026, Maruti Suzuki has emerged as India's fourth-largest EV maker by volume. "It is doing more sales in India than our plans," Takeuchi says. "We are trying to remove customer pain points around EVs with home charger installation, battery-as-a-service (BaaS) offering and assured buyback," he adds.

On the company's plans for low-cost EVs, Takeuchi says EVs will start with big cars and mid-size cars before gradually penetrating the small car segment. "An EV is a second car at home and not the first car because charging infrastructure is not perfect. Still, people would like to have a first ICE car," he says, adding that scale in EVs will come eventually.

Maruti Suzuki expects 15% of sales to come from BEVs by FY31, 25% from hybrid vehicles, 35% from CNG and 25% from ICE (internal combustion engine) or flex-fuel vehicles.

"If you move to EVs very quickly, you cannot make it

fully in India. The development of ecosystem and sales should happen simultaneously," says Takeuchi, adding that Maruti Suzuki is setting up an ecosystem to help make rare earth elements in India.

While the carmaker currently imports battery packs from China's BYD, Takeuchi says the company is in talks with local cell manufacturers for when they start production. "If you rely on some specific source for components and materials, it is high risk because you will be controlled by that company or country who is the sole supplier of that component," he cautions. Imports of lithium-ion cells have gone up five-fold over the past five years to ₹41,667 crore in FY26 with China accounting for 84% of battery cell imports. For rare earths, the dependence is even higher at 85-90%.

Maruti Suzuki's four-decade-long journey has had a multiplier effect on India's manufacturing industry, with the automaker buying 91% of its components by value from suppliers in India and creating hundreds of jobs not only within factories but also across parts suppliers, transport and other ancillary businesses. **BT**

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